



Prepared: June 18, 2026

Google Ads Management

Problems Faced & Their Impact

Blottman Law — Ontario Traffic Ticket Defence

Google Ads Account ID: 858-621-4705 | Period: Engagement to date (June 2026)

Purpose of This Document

This document is an honest, plain-language account of the obstacles encountered while managing the Blottman Law Google Ads account since Stenth took over. It exists to give full transparency on **why results have been slower than everyone wants**. The core message is straightforward: the majority of these problems were either **inherited from the previous account setup** or are **access blockers outside our control** — not a lack of demand for the service or a lack of work on the account. Each problem below is shown with what happened, how it affected the campaigns, and where it stands today.

The single most important takeaway is at the end (Section 5): the biggest unlock for stronger, more consistent results is restoring website and analytics access so we can track leads properly — without it, Google's automated system is effectively learning blind.

01 — Problems Inherited From the Previous Setup

These issues existed in the account before Stenth took over. Much of the early work was spent cleaning these up before genuine optimisation could even begin.

1. Conversion tracking was a “junk drawer”

What happened	The account had roughly 25 overlapping conversion actions — a dozen enabled at once, with 6+ duplicate call actions and inconsistent values (\$0 / \$1 / \$10 / \$150 / \$500).
Effect on campaigns	Google's automated bidding could not tell a real lead from noise, so it was optimising toward unreliable signals. This wastes budget and is a primary cause of inconsistent results.
Status	Audited and rationalised; the misleading 'Contact Us' count was correctly demoted so bidding no longer chases it. Root fix depends on website access (see Section 2).

2. Multiple redundant, overspending campaigns

What happened	Several near-duplicate Performance Max campaigns ran simultaneously — one spending roughly double its daily budget — pushing total spend over \$100/day with no real control.
Effect on campaigns	Budget was burned on the client's own campaigns competing against each other instead of reaching new customers, inflating cost-per-lead.
Status	Consolidated onto the single best campaign (PMAX - Blottman Max); duplicates paused. ■ Done.

3. A hacked old domain was still wired into the account

What happened	The previous domain blottmanlaw.com (different from the live blottman.com) had been compromised and flagged by Google for gambling/malware content. 24 ad links plus a promotion still pointed to it, sitting disapproved in the account.
Effect on campaigns	A live policy liability that risked dragging down the entire account's standing with Google — the kind of thing that can lead to account-level penalties if left attached to live ads.
Status	All 24 compromised links plus the promotion were detached from every active campaign. ■ Done (June 16).

4. Misleading ad claims baked into the inherited copy

What happened	Phrases like “98% Win Rate”, “#1 Lawyer” and “100% Representation” are written into roughly 30 ads. Google treats unverifiable statistics and superlatives as a “ Clickbait ” policy violation.
Effect on campaigns	This is currently limiting the best campaign (PMAX) — it is throttled right now because of this inherited copy. Limited campaigns serve less and produce fewer leads.
Status	Diagnosed in full; compliant replacement copy drafted and ready. Being coordinated before applying (it affects multiple campaigns at once).

5. Campaigns had no — or incorrect — location targeting

What happened	The main PMAX campaign was set to serve anywhere in the world (no location limit). Other campaigns were mis-targeted to Sarnia/Windsor instead of the Greater Toronto Area.
Effect on campaigns	This was the direct source of the out-of-province and out-of-area leads the client reported (including calls from New York and Massachusetts). Money spent reaching people who could never become clients.
Status	Corrected to Ontario-only, presence-based targeting; mis-targeted duplicates paused. ■ Done.

02 — External Blockers Outside Our Control (the biggest drag)

These are the most significant constraints on results — and they are not advertising decisions. They are access and infrastructure problems that limit what any advertiser could achieve on this account.

6. Website access was lost — nobody has it

What happened	No one currently has access to edit blottman.com, so we cannot install the proper conversion tracking tag on the website.
Effect on campaigns	Form submissions do not register as conversions. This is the root of the tracking problem described in #9 below and the single largest constraint on performance.
Status	Recovery paths documented; installation guide is written and ready the moment access is restored. ■ Waiting on client.

7. The website rebuild was promised, then cancelled

What happened	Our optimisation plan (Phase 1) depended on a new website with clean tracking and working landing pages. The client withdrew from the rebuild partway through.
Effect on campaigns	We had to re-scope the entire plan around the existing, partly-broken site — limiting how far the campaigns can be optimised.
Status	Plan re-scoped to the existing site. Ongoing constraint.

8. A key landing page was broken

What happened	blottman.com/traffic-tickets — the page several ads pointed to — was returning a broken page (confirmed by the client).
Effect on campaigns	Ads were sending paid clicks to a dead page, wasting spend and losing leads that had already been paid for.
Status	All affected ads immediately repointed to the working homepage. ■ Done.

9. ROOT CAUSE — too few tracked leads for the system to learn from

What happened	Because the form tag cannot be installed (no website access) and analytics access was also lost, Google only “sees” about 5 confirmed quality conversions per month. Automated bidding needs roughly 15–30 per month to optimise properly.
Effect on campaigns	This is the #1 technical reason results are inconsistent: the system literally cannot learn with so little data. It is a tracking and access problem — not a demand problem.
Status	Fully diagnosed. Resolving it depends on restoring website + analytics access. ■ Waiting on client.

03 — Google Platform & Policy Issues

These stem from how Google's platform and its policies treat legal/criminal-defence advertising. They affect every advertiser in this category, not just this account.

10. The “calls went dark” incident (June 9–11)

What happened	Ad delivery collapsed from 721 impressions (Jun 9) to 66 (Jun 10) to effectively zero (Jun 11). Cause: Google's “Commission of a crime in personalised advertising” policy, which automatically throttles delivery for legal/criminal-defence content.
Effect on campaigns	Roughly three days of near-zero leads — the most visible “slow” period the client experienced.
Status	Diagnosed and fixed the same day; delivery recovered. PMAX is now the account's strongest lead source again. ■ Resolved.

11. Legal/criminal content is permanently policy-restricted

What happened	Traffic and criminal-defence content carries a permanent Google policy label that limits the use of personalised targeting tools.
Effect on campaigns	A structural headwind for any law-firm advertiser: it removes some of the targeting levers available to other industries, making delivery more fragile.
Status	Managed by avoiding the triggers (e.g. no audience signals on these asset groups). Ongoing.

12. Performance Max auto-expands beyond our direct control

What happened	Performance Max automatically spreads ads across Search, Display, YouTube and Gmail. Keywords are treated as “hints”, not hard limits.
Effect on campaigns	Some irrelevant impressions and calls (parking, immigration, etc.) slip through despite extensive negative-keyword work — a known platform limitation we continuously manage.
Status	Ongoing: large negative-keyword lists maintained; final URL expansion turned off; junk campaigns paused.

04 — Operational & Coordination Issues

These relate to how leads are handled once generated, and to the pace of changes requested — areas where the outcome depends on factors beyond the ad platform itself.

13. Speed-to-answer on incoming calls

What happened	Of roughly 1,100 total calls generated, about half were under 30 seconds — i.e. missed calls or voicemail hang-ups.
Effect on campaigns	We are delivering the phone calls, but a large share are not being answered. Leads generated is not the same as leads captured — unanswered calls look like “no results” even when the ads are working.
Status	Flagged for the client; faster call answering would directly convert existing volume.

14. Uncertainty over whether form submissions are received

What happened	Our data showed about 35 form fills in one week; the client reported receiving only 5–10. Without website access we cannot verify where the others went (spam folder, broken email forwarding, etc.).
Effect on campaigns	Real leads may be arriving but never reaching the client's inbox — which would explain a perceived lack of results despite recorded activity.
Status	Requires website/email-backend access to confirm. ■ Waiting on client.

15. Frequent reactive changes forced by urgent requests

What happened	Repeated urgent requests to “bring back the old campaigns” and “get leads now” forced several major changes within short windows (the Jun 9–11 period alone saw three learning resets in 48 hours).
Effect on campaigns	Every major change resets Google's learning phase. Stacking changes suppresses delivery — stability is what produces consistent results, and constant changes work directly against it.
Status	Ongoing: we now recommend spacing major changes and avoiding bundling them.

05 — What This Means & The Fastest Path to Better Results

The honest summary: the slowdown is real, but its causes are overwhelmingly (a) inherited problems we have been cleaning up, and (b) access blockers outside our control — not a lack of effort or a lack of market demand.

Two things are already going right:

- **The lead engine is working and improving.** PMAX produced 4 quality calls in a single recent day, and 10 quality calls in the last 7 days — versus only 5 in the entire prior month. The trend is clearly upward.
- **The account is now clean and healthy.** Compromised assets removed, geo fixed, junk campaigns paused, delivery recovered, negatives in place.

What we need from the client to accelerate:

Priority	What we need	Why it matters
1 — Highest	Website access (or the web developer's contact)	Lets us install proper lead tracking so Google can finally learn — the single biggest unlock for consistent results.
2 — High	Confirm form submissions are reaching the inbox	Determines whether real leads are being lost before they reach the client.
3 — High	Faster answering of incoming calls	Roughly half of calls go unanswered today; answering them converts volume we already generate.
4 — Medium	Analytics (GA4) access	Allows us to import website lead data as conversions without any code change.
5 — Medium	Brand creative (images + a short video)	Strengthens Performance Max, which is currently thin on visual assets.

With tracking restored, Google's automated bidding moves from ~5 signals per month to 30+ — the threshold where it can genuinely optimise. That, more than any single campaign change, is what will turn recovering momentum into consistent, predictable lead flow.



This document was prepared by **Stenth** for the exclusive use of **Blottman Legal Services**. All performance data sourced directly from the Google Ads API (Customer ID 858-621-4705). Generated: June 18, 2026.